TURKEYTHAW.COM USDA HOLIDAY KITCHEN CHEAT-SHEET

Official USDA FSIS Conduction Standards | Science-Backed Food Safety

ACTIVE SCHEDULE CONFIGURATION:

Selected Weight: **16 lbs** | Method: **Refrigerator Thaw (<=40°F)** | Dinner Time: **04:00 PM**

1. USDA THAWING TIME MATRIX

BIRD WEIGHT
12 lbs
14 lbs
>> 16 lbs [ACTIVE]
18 lbs
20 lbs
24 lbs

2. CRITICAL USDA SAFETY THRESHOLDS

USDA DANGER ZONE: 40 F to 140 F (4 C to 60 C)

Bacteria multiply rapidly between 40 F and 140 F. Never leave raw turkey at room temperature for > 2 hours.

MANDATORY SAFE INTERNAL TEMP: 165 F (74 C)

Verify with instant-read probe in 3 spots: innermost thigh, thickest breast, and wing joint. Rest 40 min before carving.

3. COOK-DAY 5-STEP TIMELINE (CALCULATED FOR 04:00 PM DINNER)

01	07:00 AM	**Temper Bird at Room Temp -** Remove from fridge 60-90 min before roasting to take edge off chill.
02	11:45 AM	**Preheat Oven to 325 F & Season -** Pat skin completely dry with paper towels. Season cavity and tuck wings.
03	01:30 PM	**Roast Unstuffed on V-Rack -** Roast unstuffed at 325 F (approx. 13-15 min/lb for 16 lbs unstuffed).
04	03:15 PM	**Probe Temperature Verification -** Insert calibrated probe into innermost thigh. Must reach full 165 F.
05	03:20 PM	**Rest 40 Minutes & Carve -** Transfer to cutting board. Resting locks in up to 15% more juice before slicing.

4. EMERGENCY PROTOCOLS & SAFE FRIDGE STORAGE

Morning Panic Rescue: Submerge sealed bird in cold tap water (<=40 F), changing water every 30 min (30 min/lb).

Roast from Frozen: USDA confirmed safe! Roast unstuffed at 325 F for ~50% longer. Remove giblet bag at hr 2.

Safe Fridge Holding: Fully thawed raw turkey holds safely in a <=40 F fridge for 1 to 2 days before cooking.

Official USDA FSIS Guidelines | Always cook poultry to 165 F verified by instant-read thermometer. | TurkeyThaw.com

Downloaded from TurkeyThaw.com - Official USDA Thanksgiving Thawing & Cook-Day Calculator

100% USDA Compliant